

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 10

♥ Q J 10 9 8 2

♦ 8 3

♣ 6 5 2

♠ 8 7 2

♥ K 6

♦ A K J 4

♣ K Q 7 4



♠ J 9 6 4 3

♥ A 5 3

♦ 10 7 5

♣ 9 3

♠ A Q 5

♥ 7 4

♦ Q 9 6 2

♣ A J 10 8

With 16 points and a balanced hand you should open 1NT. Do not worry about the lack of a ♠ stopper, a 1NT opening does not guarantee stoppers in all four suits.

Partner raises you to 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♠ 4.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♠ 4.

Winners: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 4 : ♣ 4 : Total = 9

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

HOLD IT! JUST STEP AWAY FROM THE QUEEN OF SPADES AND NOBODY WILL GET HURT.

It's nice to have a hand where the Winner count is 9. And guess what? East probably has the ♠ K, so you can finesse on the first trick for an overtrick.

What if you tried the finesse and West had the ♠ K? And what if he then switched to the ♥ Q? And what if your opponents then took the next 6 ♥ tricks?

I think you get the idea. Win the ♠ A immediately and then take your other 8 tricks.

There are times when you have to take finesses - like when you just have to find one more winner.

This wasn't one of those times.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q J
 ♥ A 8 6 2
 ♦ Q 6 3
 ♣ 10 9 4

♠ 7 2

♥ Q 10 4 3

♦ A J 9 2

♣ Q 7 3



♠ 10 9 8 6 5 3

♥ K 7

♦ 8 4

♣ A K J

♠ A 4

♥ J 9 5

♦ K 10 7 5

♣ 8 6 5 2

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	Pass
2 ♥	Pass	2 ♠	Pass
4 ♠			
All Pass			
4 ♠ by East			

Don't think of passing. With 11 HCP and 2 length points you open 1 ♠. Partner responds 2 ♥. What is your next bid?

You must bid and you want to show that you have a bare minimum. You don't want to say 2NT because of that doubleton nothing ♦. So you rebid your 6-card ♠ suit. Partner bids 4 ♠ and everybody passes.

East plays 4 ♠. South leads the ♦ 5 on which you play dummy's ♦ 3. North wins ♦ J, plays ♦ A, then ♦ 2.

East plays 4 ♠. South leads the ♦ 5 on which you play dummy's ♦ 3. North wins ♦ J, plays ♦ A, then ♦ 2.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

You have already lost the 2 ♦ s and you sure can't escape losing the Ace of trumps. So you mustnot lose a ♣ trick. So your Plan will be to pull trumps, then finesse North for the ♣ Q.

You ruff the third ♦, play ♠ s until the ♠ A appears. When you regain the lead you pull any outstanding trumps, play one high ♣, (in case someone has a singleton ♣ Q), then enter dummy with the ♥ A and make the ♣ finesse. Half of the time you make the contract, the other half you don't.

You were lucky that the ♣ Q was with North.

It's never great when the success of your contract depends on a finesse, but sometimes that's your only hope - a 50% chance.